

A or P:

APA:

Claims:

Cite:

Construct:

Contract:

DR:

Graph:

IT:

LC:

Limits:

Mech:

Names:

NG:

Seq:

Source:

SP:

SV:

SvB:

Theory:

TW:

WvA:

WvW:

WvA:

Trans:

Comments on Grading Writing Assignments

Write more actively. Use the active voice. Avoid the passive voice

Not consistent with APA Manual formatting. Please consult the APA Manual 5th Edition

Your claims about differences between populations, participants, etc. need to be grounded in research or you must tenor your claims and state them as "possibilities".

Citation needed

Your explanation or description of a psychological construct should be clear and unambiguous to the reader, especially for those constructs that are extremely relevant to your project. You can assume that the reader is knowledgeable in the research area, but a brief description is necessary to clarify ambiguities concerning unfamiliar constructs.

Avoid contractions

Disembodied reference/lacking a referent - it, this, these, those, etc.

The graphs do not include or reflect the data relevant to your predictions. You should have separate graphs for individual analyses, no more, no less. Present the data that are part of your primary manipulation in the same graph so that readers can make the visual comparisons while they read about your predictions or interpretation. Presenting more data in the graph than is covered in an analysis would call for another graph and analysis.

Do not start a sentence with "it." What does "it" reference?

Lacks clarity about your thoughts or claims. Sentence lacks clarity. What do you mean specifically?

Your limitations should be legitimate concerns that would confound your data. That is, something that you manipulated potentially affected one condition differently from another. You should only list manipulations or procedures that affect all conditions in your experiment if they create either ceiling or floor effects in your data that may affect your interpretation. Do not offer inconsequential limitations

You do not specify the mechanism responsible for causing the effects or you do not provide a context for it to follow logically from theory. The theory, the mechanism that is set forth in the theory, and the predictions must be completely linked and defined in the introduction.

First names are avoided unless necessary to distinguish between two authors with the same last name. Even then, first initials are used for that distinction.

Not grammatical. Revise.

Using sequences or order: If you say "on the one hand" you have to say "on the other hand" and vice versa. You cannot use "second" or "third" without using "first" beforehand.

Are these original sources or secondary sources? Clarify the origin of the research and make sure to read and cite original work only.

Subjects versus participants

Lacking statistical Validity. Either your analyses do not really follow from your predictions or you have used the incorrect statistic for your analyses. If you have a 2x2 design, you need to conduct the proper analysis so that you can interpret your data appropriately. Also, your design and manipulations need to follow from your theory and hypothesis.

Since versus because. Since is a preposition of time that indicates the beginning point of an action or some action that has occurred after some passage of time. Because is not used for referencing time, but is used to introduce the idea of cause or reason for an action.

The theoretical motivation is unclear.

That versus who

While or Whereas versus Although

While versus Whereas

While versus Whereas versus Although

Transition needed. Although your ideas might be good, a transition between your thoughts or is weak.